Parks Commission Recreation - Report 8/12/2026

Dunbar Community Center

Youth Programs

• **Summer Day Camp** concluded July 23; full enrollment, weekly field trips, and an end of summer bash.
• **Star Student Afterschool** registration opens August 1.

Youth Athletics

• **Track**: 30 participants, two successful meets, program ended July 25.
• **Flag Football, Cheer, Volleyball Clinic, Volleyball**: Registration ongoing; all begin in August.

Adult & Senior Programs

• **Line Dancing**: Strong participation weekly.
• **Senior Active & Aging**: 29 registered participants.

Special Events & Community Use

• **Back-to-School Event** August 1 (Free) Hosted by the Omega Psi Phi Fraternity.
• Tennis courts and park areas used daily for recreation and fitness.

Meetings & Events

• Dunbar Gardens meeting: 12 attendees (July 28).
• Trucker Hat Event: 72 attendees (July 30).

Facility Improvements

• New washer/dryer installed.
• Lobby TV mounted.
• New A/C units installed in gym.



Southwest Community Center

Youth Programs

• **Summer Laureate & Youth Engagement**: 100 participants; successful end-of-summer bash.
• **Junior Botanist Program** (with Dunbar Gardens): Youth assisted in sustainable gardening and received awards.
• **Youth Dance**: M/W 5-7 p.m., Sat 9-11 a.m.
• **Free Art Night**: Wednesdays, 6–8 p.m.

Youth Athletics

• **Track & Field**: Two meets; all participants received awards.
• **Learn to Swim Program**: $50 for 5 sessions; morning/evening options.
• **Youth Football**: Skills and drills began July 6.

Adult Programs

• **Southwest Steppers Dance Workout**: Social media coverage (Dancing at Dusk).
• **Art Class**: 18+, last Tuesday each month.
• **Walking Club**: 4 members; trails with staff support.
• **Low-Impact Senior Workout**: 15 participants.
• **Pickleball Beginners**: Enrollment opened July 23.

Special Events
Midnight Basketball: Thursdays & Fridays, avg. 25–30 participants; concluded July 31.
Swimming Pool
• **Movie Night at the Pool** planned before summer closure.

Stephens Community Center
Attendance
• **July Total**: 14,826
Programs & Activities
• Parents Night Out: 25
• Game Night: 31
• Summer Day Camp: 120 participants; successful close July 23
• Youth Track & Field: 33 participants, two meets
• Cheerleaders: 30 participants
Outreach & Staffing
• Marketing at Stephens Elementary.
• Vacancies: Recreation Programmer; Custodial positions.
Maintenance
• Ceiling leak, floor line needs, fallen drain pipe (work orders submitted).
Upcoming Events
• **Layne Day Back-to-School Feast** – Aug 1
• **Taste of Stephens** – Sept 23 ($5)

West Central Community Center
Youth Sports
• Track, Flag Football, Cheer, Volleyball all advertised for fall; track had two successful meets.
Classes
• Karate: 25 participants across age groups
• Youth Dance: 10 participants
• Adult Line Dancing: ~50 participants (Tues–Thurs)
Programs & Activities
• Summer Day Camp ended July 23.
• Late Night Basketball: Thurs/Fri evenings
• Teen evening basketball after 6 p.m.
• Senior Fitness (Mon–Fri): chair stability, yoga, aerobics, nutrition, flexibility, strength training.
Staffing
• 2 Activity Assistants.
Upcoming
• LRPD using Banquet Room Aug 3–7.

East Little Rock (ELR) Community Center

Training & Events

• Cybersecurity Series

• Summer Day Camp: Full programming including talent show, skating, swimming, archery, safety training, and visits from police, fire, MEMS.

Program Attendance

• July 1–23: 682

• June 8–July 23 Total: 1,608

Community Use

• Neighborhood association, outdoor courts, park areas used 3–5 days/week.

Maintenance

• Ongoing grounds upkeep; tennis courts need refurbishment.

Meetings

• July 13 neighborhood meeting canceled; next Aug 10.

Upcoming

• **Back-to-School Physicals & Immunizations** – Aug 22, 9 a.m.–1 p.m.

Senior Affairs Division

Community Outreach

• Baptist Health monthly outreach and screenings at Dunbar, East LR, and Southwest.

• Food distributions at multiple locations.

Events

• Family Feud, Spelling Bee, Casino trips, Fourth of July celebrations.

• Speakers from ArchWell Health and Hospice specialists.

• Popcorn & Bingo Fridays.

Monthly Activities

• Chair Volleyball, Bean Bag Baseball, Bingo, Arts & Crafts, Guest Speakers, Field Trips, Line Dancing, Senior Fitness, Walking Club, Quilting, Jewelry/T-shirt Making, Table Games, and more.

Upcoming

• **West Central Talent Show** – Sept 18

Therapeutic Recreation

Summer Programs

• Adult Program: Full enrollment (20); attendance 357

• Youth Program: Full enrollment (20); attendance 385

Fall Programs

• Registration opened July 27; Fall begins Aug 10

• Programs include Branch Out Adult Day Program, Adult Community Outings, Time Out for TR.

Activities & Events

• Annual TR Water Wars and Fourth of July Celebration.

Upcoming Special Events

• **Logan's Run** – Sept 26, War Memorial Park (non-competitive 2K for youth with disabilities). This is the Kickoff for **2026 All-Abilities Little Rock Marathon** – March 6.

Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics

Membership & Revenue

• **Memberships**: 2,444 sold in July (410 new)

• **Revenue**: $58,748.19

Attendance

• Facility: 16,127

• Outdoor Pool: 1,603 daily passes



Programs

• 19 group fitness classes; senior fitness averaging 55 per class.

• Swim lessons (Session 2): 103 participants.

Special Events

• Pilates Daily Core – 67 attendees

• Movie Night at the Pool – 80 attendees

Misc.

• Outdoor Pool closed 5 days due to heat index >105°F.

Centre at University Park

Under Renovation

Youth Athletics

• Track & Field: 141 registered; concluded July 25

• Flag Football: 93

• Cheerleading: 46

• Volleyball: registration open

Adult Athletics

• Interstate Sports Complex field rentals increasing (Mon–Thurs).

• Allsop and Murry Park usage slowed due to heat.

• Adult corporate softball league: 14 teams through Aug 14.

Summer Day Camp

• Completed July 23; all locations at max enrollment.

First Tee Golf

Revenue

• YTD Gross Sales through July 28: $203,995.50 (up 0.24% from 2025).

Maintenance

• New sod in tee boxes; driving ranges in good condition.

Aerification

• Completed July 6–8; Golf courses aerify greens to relieve soil compaction from heavy foot traffic and to remove thatch. This vital process allows oxygen and water to reach the roots, prevents root suffocation, and ensures the turf remains healthy enough to survive seasonal weather changes.

Rebsamen Golf

Attendance & Revenue

• 3,809 rounds of golf; 1,126 range buckets sold

• Revenue: $132,383

Maintenance

• Dead tree removal (Hole 10) and drainage repair upcoming.

Tournaments

• Weekly 9-hole scramble on Thursdays.

Improvements

• Updated Mulligan's Grill menu, more volunteer marshals/starters to improve pace of play.

Rebsamen Tennis

Tournaments

• Junior tournament: 150 players from 10 states

• Adult wooden racquet tournament: ~75 players

Programs & Leagues

• Mixed Doubles, Tri-Level USTA teams, summer men's leagues, new USTA singles league (20 players).

• Strong Red Ball beginner league participation.

Maintenance

• Court resurfacing completed.

Museum of Arkansas Military History

Attendance

• July Total: 4,314

• YTD: 19,109

Programs & Outreach

• 2,161 youth served in June/July outreach
• Weekly offsite programs delivered by staff
• New traveling exhibits and professional development programs ongoing



Gift Shop & Fundraising

• Gift Shop: $1,547.21 (July); $7,932.44 YTD
• Fundraising: $1,375 (July); $17,180.25 YTD

Special Events

• America 250 Celebration (July 4) – 1,500+ attendees
• Movie screening July 21 drew record 118 attendees

Exhibits & Upcoming Programs

• Clara Barton exhibit opens Aug 1
• Multiple exhibits, tours, and special events scheduled through September

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Outdoor Recreation

Program Attendance

• Adults: 231
• Youth: 192

Facility Use

• War Memorial Disc Golf Course: 974 players
• Office Space: 60 adults, 97 youth

Activities

• Weekly trail rides, river trail rides, NICA events, archery and fishing programs.

Maintenance

• Regular upkeep of disc golf course.

Accomplishments

• Staff completed Wilderness First Aid recertification
• Listed outdoor guide on Guide ARK
• Facebook page surpassed 1,000 followers